

Gen Z: Hyper-connected yet shallow relations

In an age where friendships are as easy as a “follow” or a “like,” Gen Z finds itself **paradoxically** more **isolated** than ever

In a world where friendships are just a tap away, Gen Z is paradoxically more connected and yet more alone than ever. With **countless** social media networks, endless group chats, and online “friends,” you’d think they’d feel fulfilled. But under the endless likes, comments, and selfies, there’s a **haunting emptiness**.

I **often** meet young people who, despite their **vast** online networks, feel **utterly** isolated. They are connected to everyone, yet truly close to no one. Take Rhea, a 22-year-old with a picture-perfect online life. Her feed is filled with smiling photos, **exotic** vacations, and **witty** captions. But behind this **flawless facade** lies a young woman **scarred** by painful experiences. She lost her father at five, faced years of **abuse**, and carries a deep, invisible **wound**. Rhea carefully hides this pain, **crafting** an online **persona** that feels safe and acceptable. “I keep thinking if I post the right picture, maybe I’ll finally feel like I belong,” she admitted once, her voice breaking.

Yet the emptiness doesn’t **fade**. Her online “friends” see the bright exterior, but none see the broken girl within. Another story is of Arjun, a young man shaped by a **chaotic** home and constant content **bombardment**. Now 20, he spends hours scrolling through his feed, comparing himself to others who appear effortlessly perfect. “Everyone seems so complete,” he said, “but I feel like I’m failing.”

In a crisis, Arjun realises he has no one to truly **rely on**. **His friendships**, based on memes and brief **exchanges**, **feel** hollow when life gets tough. The endless scrolling only deepens his loneliness, as he sees everyone’s best moments while silently suffering through his worst. Rhea and Arjun’s stories **echo** a painful truth for many in Gen Z. Friendships today are often shallow, based on convenience rather than commitment.

They form and dissolve easily, leaving young people **adrift in a sea of acquaintances** who **vanish** when things get real. This generation’s friendships are filtered through screens, built on quick likes and **superficial** messages. The traditional **bonds** of trust and time **are** slipping away, leaving behind connections that feel **fleeting** and, ultimately, empty. What’s missing here is depth — the kind of friendship that **stands** the test of hardship, that offers **warmth** and understanding beyond a screen.

For Rhea, there’s a wounded inner child who **craves** a friend who will listen and care beyond the “perfect” image she shows online. For Arjun, there’s a **desperate** need to find a friend who sees his struggles, not just his shared posts. As a society, we need to understand that true friendship isn’t about quick exchanges or temporary **validation**.

It’s about sharing real moments, both joyful and painful. It’s about listening, being there, and caring without conditions. **Perhaps**, as Felice Buscaglia once said, “It’s not enough to have lived.” True living

means creating joy, sharing love, and holding each other through life's storms. Until Gen Z learns to build friendships beyond the screen, they'll remain in search of bonds that can truly make them feel seen, safe, and understood.

[Practice exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

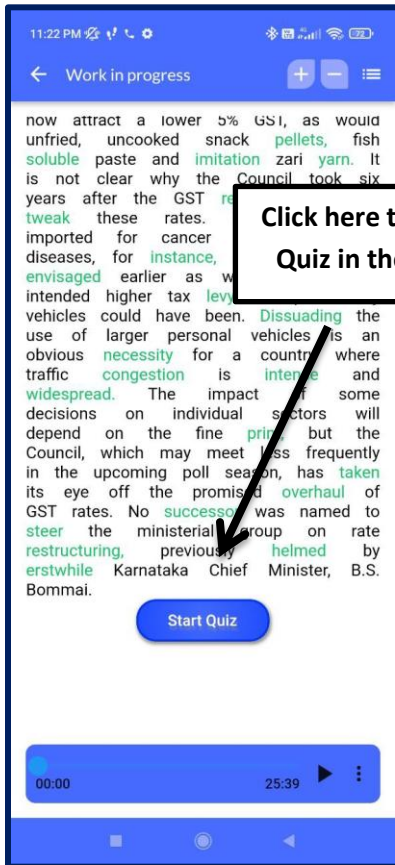
1. **Gen Z** (noun) – Generation Z, people born approximately between the mid-1990s and early 2010s जनरेशन जी (1990 के दशक के मध्य से 2010 के प्रारंभ तक जन्मे लोग)
2. **Shallow relation** (noun) – a relationship that lacks depth
3. **Paradoxically** (adverb) – Contradictorily, ironically, illogically, inconsistently विडंबना रूप से
4. **Isolated** (adjective) – Alone, solitary, secluded, detached, separated अलग-थलग, अकेला
5. **Countless** (adjective) – Innumerable, numerous, myriad, limitless, endless असंख्य, अनगिनत
6. **Haunting** (adjective) – Unforgettable, poignant, evocative, lingering, affecting मन को छू लेने वाला, भावपूर्ण
7. **Emptiness** (noun) – Void, hollowness, nothingness, vacancy, desolation खालीपन
8. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, repeatedly, commonly, habitually अक्सर
9. **Vast** (adjective) – Huge, immense, enormous, extensive, massive विशाल
10. **Utterly** (adverb) – Completely, totally, entirely, absolutely, thoroughly पूरी तरह से
11. **Exotic** (adjective) – Unusual, foreign, uncommon, unfamiliar, outlandish अनोखा, विदेशी
12. **Witty** (adjective) – Clever, humorous, amusing, sharp, smart बुद्धिमान
13. **Flawless** (adjective) – Perfect, impeccable, faultless, unblemished, immaculate त्रुटिरहित
14. **Façade** (noun) – Front, false appearance, mask, veneer, outward show मुखौटा
15. **Scar** (verb) – Mark, wound, injure, traumatize, leave a lasting effect घाव देना, निशान छोड़ना
16. **Abuse** (noun) – Mistreatment, harm, maltreatment, cruelty, exploitation दुरुपयोग
17. **Wound** (noun) – Injury, hurt, lesion, cut, trauma चोट
18. **Craft** (verb) – Create, design, fashion, shape, construct बनाना
19. **Persona** (noun) – Image, identity, personality, character, public face छवि
20. **Fade** (verb) – Diminish, disappear, wane, weaken, lessen फीका पड़ना
21. **Chaotic** (adjective) – Disorderly, disorganized, tumultuous, confused, turbulent अव्यवस्थित

22. **Bombardment** (noun) – Barrage, onslaught, flood, deluge, assault बौछार
23. **Rely** (on) (verb) – Depend on, trust in, count on, lean on, have confidence in निर्भर करना
24. **Exchange** (noun) – Interaction, communication, conversation, interchange, dialogue बातचीत
25. **Echo** (verb) – Reflect, mirror, resonate, repeat, resemble दोहराना
26. **Adrift** (adjective) – Aimless, directionless, floating, lost, wandering दिशाहीन
27. **A sea of something** (phrase) – a large amount or number of something
28. **Vanish** (verb) – Disappear, fade away, evaporate, dissipate, go away गायब होना
29. **Superficial** (adjective) – Shallow, surface-level, cursory, trivial, insignificant सतही
30. **Fleeting** (adjective) – Brief, transient, momentary, short-lived, passing क्षणिक
31. **Stand** (verb) – Endure, withstand, tolerate, bear, resist टिके रहना
32. **Warmth** (noun) – Affection, kindness, friendliness, cordiality, compassion स्नेह
33. **Crave** (verb) – Desire, long for, yearn for, want intensely, hanker after लालसा करना
34. **Desperate** (adjective) – Hopeless, despairing, in great need, frantic, urgent हताश
35. **Validation** (noun) – Confirmation, affirmation, approval, recognition, endorsement पुष्टि
36. **Perhaps** (adverb) – Maybe, possibly, conceivably, potentially, it could be शायद

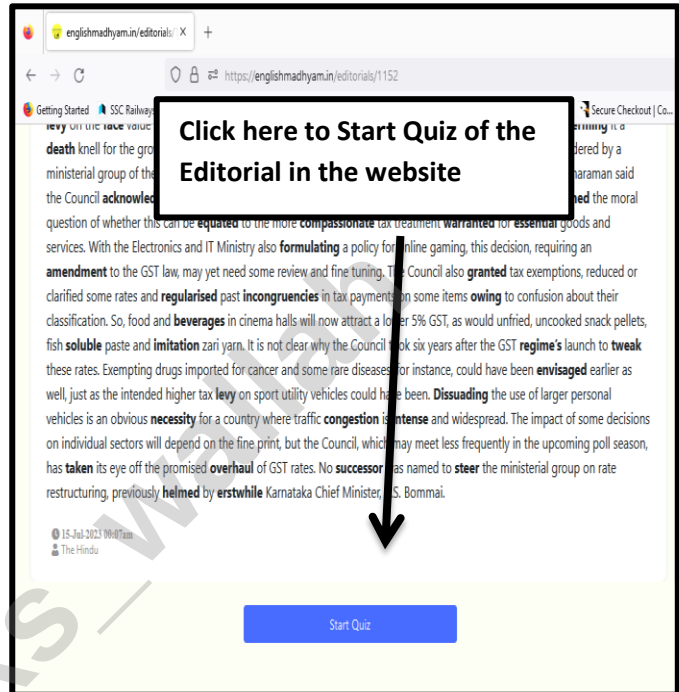
Summary of the Editorial

1. Despite Gen Z's hyper-connectivity, they experience profound isolation.
2. Social media provides easy connections but often fails to deliver meaningful relationships.
3. Friendships in the digital age are typically built on likes, comments, and superficial interactions.
4. Many young people, like Rhea, create curated online personas to seek belonging and acceptance.
5. Rhea, despite her flawless online presence, is haunted by unresolved trauma and feels disconnected.
6. Arjun, another Gen Z example, struggles with feelings of inadequacy, fueled by constant social media comparisons.
7. Arjun's friendships are shallow, rooted in memes and brief conversations, leaving him unsupported in difficult times.
8. Endless scrolling intensifies feelings of isolation, as curated feeds amplify perceptions of perfection.
9. Gen Z friendships often lack the depth and trust needed to endure hardships.
10. The convenience of digital connections leads to relationships that dissolve easily and feel empty.
11. This generation's reliance on screens undermines traditional, time-tested bonds.
12. The editorial highlights the absence of genuine warmth and understanding in modern friendships.
13. Both Rhea and Arjun yearn for connections that transcend their online personas and acknowledge their pain.
14. True friendships, the article argues, are about unconditional support and sharing real, unfiltered experiences.
15. The piece concludes that until Gen Z embraces authentic relationships, their quest for feeling seen and understood will remain unfulfilled.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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